Laura M. Stoinski

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CURRENT POSITION

since 07/2023 — **Doctoral researcher** at the University of Leipzig and the Max Planck Institute for Human Cognitive & Brain Sciences (Leipzig, Germany), supervised by **Prof. Gesa Hartwigsen** & **Prof. Martin Hebart**

EDUCATION

10/2019 – 07/2022 — **University of Leipzig**
M.Sc. Psychology: 1.0 (**GPA 4.0)**
Master's thesis: *"Semantic Representation of Objects in the Brain: Within-Category Organization by Typicality"* (fMRI)
Supervisors: Prof. Jörg Jescheniak (University of Leipzig), Prof. Martin Hebart (MPI CBS)

10/2015 – 07/2019 — **University of Constance**
B.Sc. Psychology, graduation with distinction: 1.1 (**GPA: 3.9**)
Bachelor's thesis: *"Parallel Processing of Multiple Affective Stimuli: An ERP Analysis"*
Supervisor: Prof. Harald Schupp (University of Constance)

PAST ACADEMIC POSITIONS

10/2022 – 06/2023 — Orientation scholarship/Research Associate at the Max Planck Institute for Human Cognitive & Brain Sciences (Leipzig, Germany), supervised by **Prof. Gesa Hartwigsen** & **Prof. Martin Hebart**

02/2020 – 09/2022 — Research Assistant at the "*Vision & Computational Cognition" Lab* of **Prof. Martin Hebart**, Max Planck Institute for Human Cognitive & Brain Sciences (Leipzig, Germany)

04/2018 – 08/2019 — Research Assistant at the "*General and Biological Psychology*" department of **Prof. Harald Schupp,** University of Constance (Germany)

09/2017 – 03/2018 — Internship semester at the *"Social and Cognitive Psychology"* department of **Prof. Sverker Sikström,** University of Lund (Sweden)

04/2017 – 07/2017 — Research Assistant in the "*Social Psychology & Motivation*" department of **Prof. Peter M. Gollwitzer**, University of Constance (Germany)

AWARDS

04/2025 — **Graduate Student Award**, awarded by the Cognitive Neuroscience Society (CNS).

01/2023 — **PhD scholarship (fully funded)**, awarded by the International Max Planck Research School on Cognitive Neuroimaging (IMPRS CoNI).

PUBLICATIONS/IN PREPARATION

Stoinski, L. M., Konkle, T., & Hebart, M. N. (2026). Principles of coarse-scale functional organization in occipitotemporal cortex (p. 2026.02.18.706551). bioRxiv. https://doi.org/10.64898/2026.02.18.706551

Mukherjee, K., Huey, H., **Stoinski, L. M.,** Hebart, M. N., Fan, J. E., & Bainbridge, W. A. (2026). Drawings of THINGS: A large-scale drawing dataset of 1854 object concepts. Behavior Research Methods, 58(2), 57. https://doi.org/10.3758/s13428-025-02887-w

Stoinski, L.M., Perkuhn, J. & Hebart, M.N. THINGSplus: New norms and metadata for the THINGS database of 1854 object concepts and 26,107 natural object images. *Behav Res* **56**, 1583–1603 (2024). https://doi.org/10.3758/s13428-023-02110-8

Sikström, S., **Stoinski, L. M**., Karlsson, K., Stille, L., & Willander, J. (2020). Weighting power by preference eliminates gender differences. *PLOS ONE*, *15*(11). https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0234961

CONFERENCE TALKS

Stoinski, L. M., Diego García Cerdas, Florian P. Mahner, Parsa Yousefi, & Martin N. Hebart (2025, August). Quantifying the Role of Perceived Curvature in the Processing of Natural Object Images. *The 8th annual conference on Cognitive Computational Neuroscience (CCN)*, Amsterdam, Netherlands.

Stoinski, L. M., Konkle, T., & Hebart, M. N. (2024, March). The topographic organization of diverse object properties in the human visual system*. 66th Conference of Experimental Psychologists (teaP)*, University of Regensburg, Germany.

Stoinski, L. M., Contier O., Kämmer L., & Hebart, M. N. (2024, November). From vision to semantics and back: Rethinking the function of the ventral visual system. *Colloquium of the Max Planck Institute CBS*, Leipzig, Germany.

CONFERENCE POSTER

Stoinski, L. M., Diego García Cerdas, Florian P. Mahner, Parsa Yousefi, & Martin N. Hebart (2025, August). Quantifying the Role of Perceived Curvature in the Processing of Natural Object Images. *The 8th annual conference on Cognitive Computational Neuroscience (CCN)*, Amsterdam, Netherlands.

Stoinski, L. M., Zhuang, T., Baker, C. I, & Hebart, M. N. (2025, March). Comparing the Multidimensional Mental Representations of Object Images and Object Nouns. Annual Meeting of the Cognitive Neuroscience Society (CNS), Boston, MA, USA.

Stoinski, L. M., Zhuang, T., Baker, C. I, & Hebart, M. N. (2024, September). Distilling the visual and semantic dimensions underlying mental representations of object images and nouns. *Retreat of the Collaborative Research Center (SFB) Cardinal Mechanism of Perception*, Rauischholzhausen Castle, Ebsdorfergrund, Germany

Stoinski, L. M., Katya Müller, & Hebart, M. N. (2024, May). Quantifying the role of perceived curvature in the processing of natural object images. *Annual Meeting of the Vision Sciences Society, St. Pete Beach*, FL, USA.

Stoinski, L. M., Contier, O., Konkle, T., & Hebart, M. N. (2023, May). Revisiting the animacy, size, and curvature organization of human visual cortex. *Annual Meeting of the Vision Sciences Society*, St. Pete Beach, FL, USA.

Stoinski, L. M., Perkuhn, J., & Hebart, M. N. (2022, May). THINGS+: new norms and metadata for the THINGS database of 1,854 object concepts and 26,107 natural object images. *Annual Meeting of the Vision Sciences Society*, St. Pete Beach, FL, USA.

SUMMER SCHOOLS & COLLABORATIVE VISITS

04/2025	Research visit to the laboratory of Prof. Uri Hasson, Princeton University, NJ (USA)
09/2024	1st Summer School of the International Max Planck Research School CoNI, UCL London (UK)
07/2024	ABC Summer School on “Neuro-AI: Harnessing AI to understand computation in mind and brain”, University of Amsterdam (Netherlands)
05/2023	Research visit to the laboratory of Prof. Talia Konkle, Harvard, Cambridge MA (USA)

TEACHING & SUPERVISION

Since 2023	**Co-supervision of Master students and research interns** (fMRI preprocessing; Training of DNNs and DNN feature visualization; probing for DNN-/LLM-embeddings in fMRI and MEG data)
10/2025-02/2025	Instructor for a **bachelor's seminar in Biological Psychology**, Chair of Prof. Gesa Hartwigsen, University of Leipzig
03/2018 - 08/2018	**Teaching assistant** for EEG related psychology seminars: Tutorials for EEG-Data collection & analysis, Citavi & Endnote, JASP, Excel, Literature research & writing of empirical journal articles

Skills

Programming & Statistical Software:	Python, pyTorch; HTML, CSS, JavaScript; fMRI related modules & software packages (e.g., nilearn, FSL, FreeSurfer; SPM); EEG related modules & software packages (e.g., Psychtoolbox, EEGLAB, EMEGS, SPM); R/Rstudio; SPSS/Amos; Pytorch
Other:	EEG data collection (256-channel HCGSN); Large-scale online data collection; EyeLink 1000 Eye Tracker